



QUEEN, ACTIVE c. 1300s BCE

NEFERTITI

The most famous wife of Akhenaten (see p.64), Nefertiti seems to have taken a prominent role in her husband's rule. Art of the period frequently shows her alongside her king, sharing his worship of the sun's disk. She is even depicted in warrior-like poses suggestive of royal power. Nefertiti may have died in 1338 BCE, when all record of her disappears. Some believe that Smenkhkare, a mysterious figure who seems to have ruled jointly with Akhenaten for some of his reign, was in fact Nefertiti.



AFTER

Egypt's New Kingdom had become a vast empire, increasingly difficult to police. Late in the 20th dynasty, central authority again gave way to a destabilized spell—the Third Intermediate Period (c. 1069–664 BCE).

THIRD INTERMEDIATE PERIOD

Spanning Dynasties 21 to 25, this era lasted about **400 years** and saw a complex mixture of **foreign control** and **Egyptian independence**. **Native pharaohs** in Upper Egypt gave way to a period of **Libyan** control. Lower Egypt split into **many separate regions**.

KUSHITE RULE

By the 25th Dynasty, at the end of the Third Intermediate Period, Kushite rulers from **Nubia**, notably Piye (c. 747–716 BCE) controlled both Lower and Upper Egypt under their rule, so **reunifying Egypt**.



KUSHITE PHAROAH TAHARQA WORSHIPPING THE FALCON-HEADED GOD, HEMEN

ASSYRIAN OCCUPATION

Kushite sovereignty ended with the reigns of Taharqa and Tantamani (c. 690–656 BCE). Their rule gave way to nearly a **decade of occupation** by **Assyrians 80–81** at the end of the Third Intermediate Period. Next came a brief Egyptian renaissance—the **Saite Dynasty 118**.